power of Mrauk-U kingdom. In 1580, Min Phalaung defeated the Burmese king Bayinnaung's attempt to invade Arakan. In 1598, Min Rajagri temporarily allied himself with the king of Toungoo and conquered the Mon capital of Pegu. Taking advantage of the power vacuum in Lower Burma, he then attacked and occupied the port city of Syriam. Once in control of Syriam, he appointed Portuguese mercenary and adventurer Philip de Brito e Nicota to administer the newly acquired territory. De Brito, however, had other plans. He expelled the Arakanese governor and held Syriam under the authority of the Viceroy of Goa, a Portuguese colony since the 15th century. In 1604, he defeated an attempt by Min Rajagri to attack Syriam. De Brito then forged an alliance with the Mon king Binnya Dala though marriage. In 1612, de Brito e Nicota and the king of Martaban launched an invasion of Toungoo. The king of Toungoo responded by sending forces to Syriam. The city would eventually fall in 1613 when a Mon chief opened the city's gates to let Anaukhpetlun's forces in. Following a period of turmoil in Bengal, Min Khamuang seized control of Chittagong.

Min Khamuang was succeeded by his son Thri Thudhamma Salim Shah II (r. ca. 1622–1638). His reign was characterized by a period of relative prosperity as foreign trade brought wealth. Thri Thudhamma was poisoned by Queen Nat Shin Mai. Following his death, his son Min Sanay became king. He ruled for only 21 days before he, too, was poisoned by Queen Nat Shan Mai. The queen's consort minister Nga Kutha was declared king with the title Narapaigyi (r. ca. 1638–1645). He then went on to a large number of royal clansmen and ministers to consolidate control. Narapaigyi was succeeded by his son Thadu Mintra (r. ca. 1645–1652) who was succeeded by his son Sanda Thudhamma (r. ca. 1652–1684). The death of Sanda Thudhamma brought a period of political instability to Arakan. A century of chaos followed in which the political authority broke down as a series of kings occupied the throne. From 1685 to 1710 there were 10 kings who reigned for an average of two and a half years. By the middle of the 17th century political order had completely broke down.

The Mrauk-U dynasty would continue until the late 18th century, when a power struggle among the Arakanese nobility was exploited by the Burmans. In 1782, Thadoe Aung, the duke of Rambree, ascended the throne. He was accorded the regal sounding title of “Mahasamada” (great elect president) by the Mun Ataiban (the royal assembly of lords). A rival